



LAKEWOOD CITY COUNCIL MINUTES

Monday, April 6, 2026

City of Lakewood

6000 Main Street SW

Lakewood, WA 98499

<https://us02web.zoom.us/j/86872632373>

Dial +1(253) 215- 8782 Participant ID: 868 7263 2373

CALL TO ORDER

Mayor Bocchi called the meeting to order at 7:00 p.m.

ROLL CALL

Councilmembers Present: 7 – Mayor Paul Bocchi, Deputy Mayor Patti Belle, Councilmembers Ellen Talbo, Michael Brandstetter, Philip Lindholm (virtual), Ryan Pearson and J. Trestin Lauricella.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

Mayor Bocchi led the Pledge of Allegiance.

PROCLAMATIONS AND PRESENTATIONS

Proclamation recognizing April 25, 2026 as Parks Appreciation Day.

MAYOR BOCCHI PRESENTED A PROCLAMATION RECOGNIZING APRIL 25, 2026 AS PARKS APPRECIATION DAY TO JASON GERWEN, CHAIR, PARKS AND RECREATION ADVISORY BOARD.

Proclamation recognizing April 13, 2026 – April 17, 2026 as Black Wellness Week.

DEPUTY MAYOR BELLE PRESENTED A PROCLAMATION RECOGNIZING APRIL 13, 2026 – APRIL 17, 2026 AS BLACK WELLNESS WEEK TO CHRISTINA BLOCKER, ELEVATE BLACK WELLNESS.

Youth Council Report.

Youth Councilmember Damian Cruz Guzman shared that students are working on a mixed media production, at today's meeting they received a presentation on the Smart Program and are working towards finalizing details for the Youth Summit. Alexander Charles spoke about the Youth Summit scheduled for April 18th at Pierce College noting that 244 students are registered to attend. Discussion ensued and the City Council notified the Youth Council that they have a scheduling conflict and will be unable to participate in this year's Youth Summit.

PUBLIC COMMENTS

The City Council received written comments in advance of the meeting from Michelle Le.

Roger Neal, Steilacoom resident, presented the City with a Certificate of Recognition from AARP for driver safety.

Jason Gerwen, Parks and Recreation Advisory Board, spoke in support of the H-Barn Restoration Project with leed certification and a sustainable design.

Joel Vrana, Eagle Point Homeowners Association President, spoke about the water quality on American Lake.

Joel Kangiser, Lakewood resident, spoke about water quality on American Lake and in support of assessment changes.

Paul Brice, Lakewood resident, spoke in support of retail cannabis in the City.

Christina Manetti, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to the Portland Loo and Edgewater Park redevelopment project.

Christina Manetti, Garry Oak Coalition, spoke about the clear cutting on 112th Street at Interlaaken Drive and in support of the City taking action to preserve and protect the tree canopy.

James Dunlop, Lakewood resident, spoke about Edgewater Park, turning the property into a parking lot and questioned why the City is redeveloping the park.

Terry Wise, spoke about the contract for abatement of 5105 Solberg Drive SW and the Lakewood Municipal Code related to the impervious footprint of the property.

Michelle Le, Lakewood resident, spoke about her experience in residential real estate and the contract for abatement of property at 5105 Solberg Drive SW.

Tichomir Dunlop, Lakewood resident, spoke about the clear cutting on 112th Street at Interlaaken Drive and in support of the City taking action to prevent clear cutting of trees.

Joseph Ramos, Apartment Association of Greater Los Angeles, spoke in opposition to Ordinance No. 849 related to rental licensing and inspection requirements.

C O N S E N T A G E N D A

- A. Approval of the minutes of the City Council study session of March 9, 2026.
- B. Approval of the minutes of the City Council meeting of March 16, 2026.
- C. Approval of claims vouchers, in the amount of \$4,457,692.38 for the period of February 14, 2026 through March 13, 2026.
- D. Approval of payroll checks, in the amount of \$3,082,837.44, for the period of February 16, 2026 through March 15, 2026.
- E. Motion No. 2026-23

Authorizing the execution of a grant agreement with Washington State Military Department, in the amount of \$50,009, for the Emergency Management Performance Grant.

- F. Motion No. 2026-24

Authorizing the execution of an amendment extending the term of the agreement with Keller Associates to assist in updating the Lakewood Municipal Code Title 12 and the Engineering Standards Manual.

- G. Motion No. 2026-25

Authorizing the award of an abatement contract to DP Excavation, Inc. in the amount of \$71,181.85 for the abatement of 5105 Solberg Drive SW.

- H. Motion No. 2026-26

Authorizing the award of a Community Development Block Grant (CDBG) Major Home Repair loan, in the amount of \$75,000 and a construction contract with FRN Corporation, in the amount of \$68,922.60, for the rehabilitation of 9005 Highland Ave SW.

- I. Items filed in the Office of the City Clerk:
 - 1. Community Services Advisory Board meeting minutes of January 22, 2026.
 - 2. Community Services Advisory Board meeting minutes of February 19, 2026.

3. Parks and Recreation Advisory Board meeting minutes of February 24, 2026.
4. Planning Commission meeting minutes of March 4, 2026.

Councilmember Lindholm requested that Item No. G, Motion No. 2026-25 be removed from the Consent Agenda.

COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON MOVED TO ADOPT THE CONSENT AGENDA, MINUS ITEM NO. G, MOTION NO. 2026-25. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

COUNCILMEMBER BRANDSTETTER MOVED TO ADOPT ITEM NO. G, MOTION NO. 2026-25. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON. ROLL CALL VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY WITH COUNCILMEMBER LINDHOLM ABSTAINING.

R E G U L A R A G E N D A

ORDINANCE

Ordinance No. 849 Amending Lakewood Municipal Code Chapter 5.60 related to Rental Housing Licensing and Inspection Requirements.

DEPUTY MAYOR BELLE MOVED TO ADOPT ORDINANCE NO. 849. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER LAURICELLA.

DEPUTY MAYOR BELLE REQUESTED TO CONTINUE CONSIDERATION OF ORDINANCE NO. 849 TO THE CITY COUNCIL MEETING OF APRIL 20, 2026. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

Ordinance No. 850 Enacting an additional sales and use tax of one-tenth of one percent, as authorized in section 201, Chapter 350, Laws of Washington 2025, for criminal justice purposes; creating a new section to Lakewood Municipal Code, Title 3 Revenue and Finance, Chapter 3.90 One-Tenth of One Percent Public Safety Sales Tax; and providing for severability and establishing an effective date.

DEPUTY MAYOR BELLE MOVED TO ADOPT ORDINANCE NO. 850. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER TALBO.

COUNCILMEMBER BRANDSTETTER MOVED THAT THE AUTHORIZATION OF THE SALES AND USE TAX FOR CRIMINAL JUSTICE PURPOSES OF RCW 82.14 BE SUBMITTED TO THE MUNICIPAL VOTERS AT THE NEXT AVAILABLE GENERAL ELECTION. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER LAURICELLA. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND FAILED WITH COUNCILMEMBERS LAURICELLA, LINDHOLM, PEARSON, TALBO, DEPUTY MAYOR BELLE AND MAYOR BOCCHI VOTING IN OPPOSITION.

ROLL CALL VOTE WAS TAKEN ON ORDINANCE NO. 850 AND CARRIED WITH COUNCILMEMBERS BRANDSTETTER, LAURICELLA AND LINDHOLM VOTING IN OPPOSITION.

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None.

NEW BUSINESS

None.

REPORTS BY THE CITY MANAGER

City Manager Russell reviewed the items that will come forward for discussion at the City Council study session of April 13th and shared that proclamations will be scheduled at upcoming meetings for Asian Pacific Heritage month and Human Trafficking Awareness.

He then announced the following upcoming meetings and events:

- April 9, 7 P.M., Lake City Neighborhood Association
- April 14, 6:30 P.M., Tillicum Neighborhood Association
- April 18, 8:00 A.M., City Council Retreat, City Hall Council Chambers
- April 21, 7 P.M., Fort Steilacoom Neighborhood Association
- April 22, 6 P.M., Downtown Neighborhood Association
- April 25, 9 AM, Parks Appreciation Day and Wards Lake Park Ribbon Cutting 1230 PM, Wards Lake Park

CITY COUNCIL COMMENTS

Councilmember Lauricella shared that he attended the Public Safety Advisory Committee meeting where there was discussion regarding the automatic traffic safety camera program and safety on motorized scooters or e-bikes. He shared that he looks forward to Parks Appreciation Day and the City Council Retreat.

Councilmember Lindholm requested that the City Council issue a proclamation on Human Trafficking. He thanked Mayor Bocchi for attending the Lakewood Rotary meeting.

Councilmember Talbo shared that she attended the Planning Commission meeting where there was discussion regarding the formation of the NECC Ad Hoc Committee. She thanked AARP for hosting classes in Lakewood and shared that she looks forward to the Wards Lake Park Grand Opening event.

Councilmember Brandstetter shared that he will attend the Tillicum Woodbrook Neighborhood Association meeting and meetings with South Sound 911.

Councilmember Pearson shared that last week he attended the Community Healthcare Lunch and Laughter event, the Parks and Recreation Advisory Board meeting and the Ad Hoc Planning Committee meeting for the H-Barn Restoration Project. He requested a Council discussion regarding the Resolution expressing commitment to Unified Regional Approach to Homelessness.

Deputy Mayor Belle shared that she attended the Youth Council meeting where Elijah StaAna was presented with the Lakewood First Lions scholarship and she thanked the Council for their discussions this evening.

Mayor Bocchi shared that he attended the Lakewood Rotary meeting and spoke about individuals picking up garbage in Kiwanis Park.

ADJOURNMENT

There being no further business, the meeting adjourned at 9:58 p.m.



PAUL BOCCHI, MAYOR

ATTEST:



BRIANA SCHUMACHER
CITY CLERK